

Nick Heindl

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Madison, WI, USA

Technical Designer and Accessibility Champion

Technical and resourceful designer and champion of accessibility with 10+ years of AAA gameplay XP across titles that have been enjoyed by nearly one billion players worldwide.

Nick has an infectious passion for tech design and game accessibility. He thrives when learning new technologies and collaborating with different roles. He strives to empower teams to do their best work.

“Force Multiplier”, “Mentor”, “Advocate” - all terms used by previous leads to describe Nick’s impact.

Selected Career History

ZeniMax Online Studios (Xbox, Bethesda)

New ECS-based engine, AngelScript, Custom Blueprint-like Visual Scripting, C++, C#, Figma, Miro

Unannounced AAA MMORPG

Accessibility Team Lead and Principal Technical Designer
Senior Technical Designer

July 2023 – October 2025
August 2021 – July 2023

PUBG Corporation

Unreal Engine 4, C++, PowerShell, git

PlayerUnknown’s Battlegrounds (PUBG)

Gameplay Engineer

October 2020 – July 2021

Raven Software (Activision Blizzard)

3+ proprietary engines, C++, Custom Script Language (GSC), Lua

Call of Duty: Warzone,

Call of Duty: Modern Warfare,

Call of Duty: Cold War,

Call of Duty: Black Ops IIII,

Call of Duty: Online (China)

Gameplay Engineer

Associate Gameplay Engineer

Gameplay Engineer Intern

May 2016 – October 2020
May 2016 – February 2018
Summer 2015

Education

University of Wisconsin-Madison

Computer Sciences and Linguistics

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Selected Professional Experience

ZeniMax Online Studios | Principal Tech Designer and Accessibility Team Lead

Worked closely with users in all departments to empower them and maximize their efficiency

- Created script review process, established best practices, and documented workflows
- Wrote utility libraries, exemplar content, and development tutorials
- Collaborated with various teams to triage blockers early and ensure alignment
- Onboarded multiple tech designers, Mentored designers across departments

Embedded within Narrative and Cinematic teams to bolster features, processes, and pipelines

- Technical Product Owner of Narrative Systems from first implementation to alpha
- Led efforts to assess, prototype, and scale up narrative systems, including first examples of RPG Choice & Consequence and first complex scripted quest content

Partnered with various Gameplay teams to create and tune player-facing features

- Worked with 3Cs team to balance movement and camera to minimize Sim Sickness
- Joined Combat team to revamp Aim Assist systems and create live-edit tooling

Founded and led a multi-disciplinary Accessibility Team

- Responsible for working with every other team to define roadmaps, goals, and success to ensure we were on track to meet (and exceed) legal and publishing standards
- Ran workshops, presentations, 1-1s, and contributed to Xbox-wide talks and initiatives

Directly contributed to various accessibility features through design and implementation

- Improved accessibility of internal development tools
- Performed tech evaluations of third-party software (IRIS, Chroma, and more)
- Created a technical demo to showcase assistive devices and highlight our input system
- Implemented various standards for subtitles, captions, and text scaling across 4+ platforms

PUBG Corporation | Gameplay Engineer

- Engineering feature owner for new vehicles as part of an unreleased map
- Polished a prototyped game mode launched as a limited time event
- Bolstered a new remote workflow for UE4 with git and p4 to support non-technical staff
- Assisted Tech Director with setting up a recruiting and interviewing process

Raven Software | Gameplay Engineer

- Led small team to design, architect, and implement Call of Duty Warzone's Ping Marker system
- Prototyped, polished, and shipped many features and game modes for a worldwide audience
- Built an in-game automated test tool to assist Design and QA on Call of Duty's first Battle Royale
- Designed & built player ranking system; Used live metrics to tune rewards
- Profiled code and established standards to reduce live service errors by tenfold
- Led two multidisciplinary teams in Activision-wide innovation competitions for Mobile
- Collaborated with worldwide teams to set up analytics design & instrumentation for Warzone
- Engineering mentor to interns, travelled with the University team to recruit at universities

Personal

- Actively coaching and mentoring students and presenting talks and panels to conferences
- Certified Accessible Player Experience Practitioner (CAPXP): accessible.games/apxp